



FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

VOL. 11 ISSUE #12
Dec 2024

COMING EVENTS

DECEMBER

1st Sydney Car Talk
5th Display at Erina
5th AGM & Monthly Meet
7th Central Coast Gathering
11th Committee Meeting
14th Christmas Lunch
15th Mid-Nth Coast Gather

JANUARY

Not much happening except
preparing our cars for the
new year

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AHOC visit to
the Zig Zag Rail
way - 10 Nov 2024

by Denis Kasza

Sunday 10th November was the day of our excursion to the Zig-Zag Railway on Bells Line of Road at Clarence, about 15K east of Lithgow.

It was a warm day and 25 of us, in eight Austin-Healeys, an Austin and several BJ9s, met up at McGraths Hill Maccas and other points for a great afternoon of vintage steam train nostalgia. It was good to see that the venue is

thriving again after being closed due to severe bushfire damage some years ago. The train wasn't completely full for our trip, but a sizeable crowd had turned up and there were two other trips during the day. The engineering and construction of the Zigzag railway system is truly remarkable, especially considering that it was initially built over a period of only

Cont' on page 10



POST: AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 3011
Rhodes NSW 2138

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au
WEB: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au
FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.



Design by Amy Q Design

The opinions and advice expressed in the Flat Chat Newsletter are not necessarily those of the editor or the Austin-Healey Owners Club (NSW) Inc. For technical advice it is suggested you seek professional support.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

🎵 It's beginning to feel a lot like Christmas. 🎵

The tradition at our house is that the tree and decorations come out of hibernation on the 1st December and return to their respective boxes 12 days after Christmas Day.

As I'm drafting this on 30th November it means that it's all meant to happen tomorrow. Can't say that I'm looking forward to the experience. I've begged my true love not to send me 12 partridges or even the 40 maids-a-milking; part of the 364 presents that were dispatched if you believe the words of that song this year, so the house won't be so crowded.

As this will be the last Flat Chat Newsletter for 2024 I want to take the opportunity of wishing you and your families all the best for the Christmas season and the New Year. For many, it is a time of happiness and an opportunity



Jim Phillips

to get together with friends and families, but for others that is not so, and my hope is that someone will reach out to you to befriend you during this period.

As you have all been advised, the AGM will precede the general meeting and will kick off at 7.15 to give us sufficient time to be out of the Strathfield Club by 9.00pm.

Earlier this year I indicated that I thought that we need someone to revitalise the club and make it more attractive to younger members. As I'm closer to being 90

years of age than I am to 65 years of age, I figure it was time to try to get younger members involved and therefore I will not be standing again for the role of president.

I have truly enjoyed working with the committee who voluntarily give of their time to make our club a great centre for those that own or are interested in the Austin-Healey marque, for some it has been many, many years and, in many respects, I have just been the new boy on the block. To

Cont Page 6

COMMITTEE LIST - 2024

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Jim Phillips
8 Belina Ave.,
Wyoming NSW 2250
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Vice-President - Geoff Smith
0458 777 339
m.gpsmith@bigpond.com

Secretary - Julie Lee
0421 598 755
hedli@tpg.com.au

Treasurer - Jenny Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Social Secretary - Dianne Lawlor
0413 873 191
gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Editor - Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Rd.,
Kurrajong Heights 2758
0417 673 065
p.quinn@outlook.com

Historian - Joe Armour
0419 233 099
joea6@bigpond.com

Membership Secretary - Christine Lyttle
0410 201 373
membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Regalia - Colin Rule
0467 563 523
coolibahconvertible@bigpond.com

Technical Officer - Greg Strange
02 9319 2299
gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jpjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions
Chapter Coordinators
Central Coast Colin Rule 0467 563 523
Illawarra/Sth H'lands John Thornton 0419 266 284
Mid Nth Coast Phil Loking 0412 392 362
Western Greg Poole (02) 5355 0079

CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors -
Neville Stirton - 0414 472 877 - Geoff Smith - 0458 777 339 - Phil Loking - 0412 392 362

Assn of British Car Clubs Rep - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read (D), Alan Jones (D),
Warwick Sell (D), Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick
Quinn, Terry Bancroft (D), Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's
address is:- AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 3011
Rhodes NSW 2138

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



Greetings and welcome to the December 2024 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter.

Can't say that over the last month I have been besieged with words of what you have been up to with your Austin-Healey. Apart from the reports of what the club been up to, there has only been a single contribution for our mutual benefit. Thank you to Ronnie Strange for his unique thoughts following the Car Talk morning held on Sunday 1st December.

On the cover you will find an image of steam locomotive that is domiciled at the Zig Zag Railway plus another photo showing a brace of Austin-Healeys. Yes our visit to the Zig Zag Railway was most enjoyable and the all too infrequent aroma of steam, no doubt brought back memories for many of us.

What else is in this issue?

I'm assuming that members might be still interested in the 2025 National Rally in Victoria, so have again included the booking forms and so forth starting on page 17. If the Rally attracts, but the thought

of blasting south on the Hume Highway does not, we mentioned last month that Gordon Lynas is putting together a slow tour along the coast. Gordon has updated the journey with more information, and you can read about that on page 25.

No prizes for guessing that this is the last Flat Chat Newsletter for the year and with that there are two points of interest. Yes I will continue into 2025 and there will be a January issue to maintain the boredom.

What's happening with the Quinn Austin-Healey? I can't say that the past month saw me having to wield a spanner at all. This doesn't mean that it has sat in its garage for a month, no quite the contrary. First there was the run to the Zig Zag Railway at Clarence along Bells Line of Road, which I consider as one of the best drivers' road in Australia. It was interesting that while heading west at the speed limit, there was a rather large brace of modern BMWs heading the other way. A minute or two later came the thin blue line in pursuit.

A couple of weeks later we headed north to Caves Beach, not far south of Newcastle to enjoy lunch with Ros Treloar and her partner. Longer term members will recall Doug Treloar the AHOC's treasurer during the 1970s and sadly died during the 1990s. The Quinn Austin-Healey behaved perfectly, but we found out something new about

iPhones. Did you know that if they get hot, the screen goes blank until they cool a little? The drive north was hot, and the phone didn't like it. Not good when you're relying on the inbuilt GPS. Anyway we were late because of it. Well that's our excuse. Time to install the TomTom on the inside of the windscreen. The home journey was one of those journeys that saw us driving under cloud cover as the sun set. It was lovely!

The photo below shows the car ready to join the throng heading towards the Zig Zag Railway. It was hot in the sun, so we hid amongst the shade trees.

I trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter, and as usual I am looking forward to receiving lots of words and photos of what you have been up to with your Austin-Healeys.



Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**

Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 7 November 2024

Meeting commenced at 7:40pm.

Venue - Strahfield Golf Club and via Zoom

ATTENDEES

Jim Phillips (Chair), Janice & Jeff Burton, Vince Cessario, Colin Goldsmith, George Goodare, Chris Hatch (Z), Amer Khoury, Dianne Lawlor, Garry & Julie Lee, Jenny & Ross Penman, Patrick Quinn, Bob Ratcliffe, Rod Richards, Muriel & Ray Roberts, Colin Rule, Greg Strange, Ronnie Strange, Allan Whitehouse, David Williamson.

VISITORS, NEW MEMBERS

N/A

APOLOGIES

Patricia Bancroft, Natalie Cessario, Mal French, Liz Goodare, Denis Kasza, Alan Mitchell, Caroline Quinn, John & Judy Sherman, Geoff Smith, Neville Stirton.

MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 3 October 2024, as published in the November 2024 issue of *Flat Chat*, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

- AGM: Jim reminded everyone that the AGM would be held just prior to the December general meeting, and the Club needed a new Secretary! Nomination forms for Committee positions were available.
- Meeting Venue: A few members had been checking out possibilities, but there was still nothing locked in for 2025.
- Aust Assoc of Austin Healey Clubs: Jim and Gordon were the nominees for the NSW Club. The Association would be holding a special general meeting on 27 November to change its financial year to 30 June and elect office bearers.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

No report

SECRETARY'S REPORT

AJulie advised of emails received, including:

- Various car club magazines
- Motorsport Australia – invitation to reaffiliate

for 2025 plus reminder to renew management liability insurance

- SC Parts Group were advertising seatbelts in a range of colours
- Un homme named Jean Potier from France had sent in some photos of his car, formerly owned by Richard Horwood.



Julie also said she'd be happy to offer help and support to anyone who was thinking of taking on the Secretary role.

TREASURER'S REPORT

In Jenny's absence, Jim reported on the Club's kitty as at 31 October 2024:

Term Deposit	\$110,000.00
Cash Reserve	\$2,585.49
Debit Card	\$303.82
Main Account	\$22,792.34
Total	\$135,681.65

In addition, the Charlie's Run account had a balance of \$2,486.22.

Income	
Bank Account Interest	\$2,807.69
Membership	\$230.00
Christmas Party	\$360.00
Regalia	\$2,125.00
Advertising	\$400.00

Expenses	
Christmas Party	\$441.41
Association Fees - CMC	\$125.00

MEMBERSHIP SECRETARY'S REPORT

A new member for the month was Graham Bradshaw from Breakfast Point with a 1964 Triumph Herald.

SOCIAL SECRETARY'S REPORT

Dianne asked everyone for non-perishable donations to the Christmas Hamper, to be raffled off at the AGM (\$5 per ticket). Proceeds would be going to Beyond Blue.

There were lots of social events coming up, including:

- the ZigZag Heritage Railway trip, followed by afternoon tea at the Quinn residence (10 November)
- Car Talk at Mortlake on 1 December
- a car display on 5 December at the Erina Community Men's Shed
- the Christmas Lunch on 14 December

Dianne also wanted to know if members would be interested in a twilight event in January.

Gordon Lynas was organising the 2025 Charlie's Run, plus a Slow Road to Inverloch (i.e. to the National Rally).

The Chapter convenors present also provided quick updates on what was happening.

WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Jim didn't have much to report.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

There was nothing to report from Pamela.

EDITOR'S REPORT

Patrick noted that Flat Chat was a bit fatter than usual, as there was heaps of information on the National Rally.

Ray gave the big thumbs up to Patrick for the latest edition of the Australian Austin Healey magazine.

REGISTRAR'S REPORT

Patrick didn't have much to report.

HISTORIAN

No report.

LIBRARIAN

Ronnie had nothing to report.

TECHNICAL OFFICER

Greg had the usual interesting story about a car that

had made its way into his workshop, with this one having a disconnected alternator!

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

Ross didn't have anything to report on PR, but he did have a lovely story about Edd Black, who he and Jenny had met at the National Rally in Geraldton. Edd (from Thornlie) had awarded the Penmans (from Thornleigh) with honorary membership of the Thornlie Sub-branch of the WA Club!



CMC REPORT

Greg and Ray didn't have anything to report as there hadn't been a meeting.

ASSOC. OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS REPORT

No report.

CSCA REPORT

Colin G's update was that the TSOA Super Sprint event scheduled for 24 November was looking decidedly shaky, as it needed 40 entrants to break even and to date, they only had 12. He was hoping that the MX5 Club would come on board in 2025, as that would help boost event numbers.

REGALIA

On behalf of Ray, Colin R had a 1978/79 Year Book to give away, which was quickly snaffled up by Julie. As usual, Colin also had a heap of stuff for sale.

SHOW & TELL

Of course Ray had a story to tell. But you had to be there.

FOR SALE OR WANTED

- Dianne's five 48-spoke 15" wheel rims went into Colin's regalia stash
- Patrick had bought in a bunch of old Motor Sport magazines free to anyone who wanted them
- Stuart McColl had two 12-port heads for sale

GENERAL BUSINESS

There was no general business.

Meeting concluded at 8:35pm.



Social Report

Dianne Lawlor 0413 873 191

gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Denis Kasza 0407 492 008

deniskasza@gmail.com

Our November activities began with the Central Coast Chapter's gathering on 2 November, followed by the visit to the Zig Zag Railway at Clarence.

Then the Mid-North Coast's regular meeting was on the 16th November followed by the Illawarra and Southern Highlands Chapters' Christmas get-together at Gerringong on the 20th. Read more about these excellent events elsewhere in this month's Flat Chat newsletter.

We have some more exciting events planned for December: on Sunday 1st it's the Sydney Car Talk, then on Thursday 5th there will be a morning visit to Erina Men's Shed on the Central Coast and that evening sees our AGM. These events will be followed by the Central Coast Chapter's Christmas drive event on Saturday December 7th and the club's Christmas Lunch Party, which will take place on Saturday 14th December at Sydney Rowers Club, Abbotsford from 12.30pm.

Please bring your donations for the Christmas Hamper to Dianne Lawlor at the AGM for the raffle, which will be drawn at the Christmas Party. Tickets will be \$5, proceeds will go to Beyond Blue Charity.

Event: Sydney Car Talk Meeting

Date: Sunday December 1st

Venue: Mortlake SLSC, 2 Bennett St, Mortlake

Time: 8.30am to 11am

Contact: Denis Kasza 0407 492 008

Please bring a contribution to morning tea. Sausage sizzle brunch provided

Event: Erina Men's Shed 10th Anniversary Car Display

Date: Thursday 6th December

Venue: 6 Carlton Rd, Holgate 2260

Time: from 9am, 10am optional half hour church service, followed by a tour of Men's Shed Morning tea and barbecue lunch provided

Contact: as above

Event: Central Coast Chapter workshop run

Date: Saturday 7th December

Meet: 9am Ourimbah Rest Area

Morning tea: Mangrove Creek Dam - please bring your thermos and goodies

Lunch: Springs Restaurant, Peats Ridge

Details: December Flat Chat Newsletter

Contact: Jenny Richter, 0428 180 570

Event: Christmas Lunch Party

Date: Saturday December 14th 2024

Time: 12.30pm

Venue: Sydney Rowers Club, Abbotsford

Cost \$40 per head, payable to AHOC account

Please RSVP on the AHOC website

Contact: Christine Lyttle 0410 301 373

membership@austininhealeynsw.com.au

Event: Mid-North Coast Chapter Workshop

Dates: Third Saturday of each month, beginning February

Venue: 79 Barton St, Croki

Time: 9am to 12pm (please register in advance)

Contact: Phil Lorking 0412 392 362

thelorkings@outlook.com

Please bring a contribution to morning tea

President's Message Cont'

those members, on your behalf as well as my own, I say a huge thank you.

In relation to the meeting venue, several members have recommended, visited and reported on alternative sites following the reorganisation at Strathfield's management. After some negotiation it has been agreed that we can continue to use the meeting room that we occupied last month at no cost, provided that we continue to avail ourselves of the services provided by the bistro and bar. As some of the other

venues contacted involve room hire charges which, in some cases, will be reduced or erased if we use the dining facilities, but for which we need to make formal application. At this stage it is probably best that we review the options that we have and make a decision based on what is going to be best for the members. A job for the New Year.

Jim Phillips
President

YOU ARE INVITED TO

RSVP ON WEBSITE

CHRISTMAS LUNCH PARTY

FOOD . DRINKS . FRIENDS

SATURDAY 14 DECEMBER AT 12.30 PM

**Sydney Rowing Club,
Watergrill
613 Great North Road
Abbotsford NSW 2046**

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Contact: Vince Cessario AHOC Member

info@platinumsash.com.au
13 Widdam Street - Artarmon NSW 2054

Membership Report

by Christine Lyttle

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Merry Christmas to members and their families. Be nice to one another and enjoy the festive season and have a Happy New Year.

New memberships this month are: Murray West from Paddington; and Ian Elbourne from Bathurst. Both memberships are pending as awaiting payment on website applications.

We welcome both Murray and Ian to our club and hope to meet with them soon.

Thank you to the members that have sent changes to

their details on the website - these have been updated (or will be updated if you have given a date for change). Please continue to send any changes to your details by email to the above email address.

Look forward to seeing you at General Meeting and the Christmas Party!

Happy Healeying,
Christine Lyttle

Christmas Party

Bookings will be closed by the time you read your magazine though if for any reason you may be able to attend, check with me as there may be a cancellation that could be filled, send me an email to the above address.



AHOC Christmas Hamper Raffle



There will be a raffle of a Christmas Hamper at the AHOC's Christmas Lunch Party on Saturday December 14th, to be held at the Sydney Rowers Club, Abbotsford.

Tickets will be \$5, with the proceeds going towards the Beyond Blue Charity.

In the past, the AHOC NSW has supported various charities and at the committee meeting before last it was decided to reinstate this.



Donations by club members of hamper items will make up the prize, so we are asking members if they could please contribute by bringing such items to the December general meeting and giving them to Dianne Lawlor, who will be preparing the hamper.

Alternatively, you could drop the goodies in to Dianne at Gregory Strange Motor Mechanic, 117 Cleveland St Darlington.



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Conditional (Historic Vehicle) Registration you should read this.

I knew it wouldn't last, but I did enjoy a whole month when I wasn't asked how to renew Conditional Registration. For one fleeting moment I thought I might not include the advice below, but it's not to be, so if you're having to renew the Conditional Registration of your vehicle read the below. It's really straightforward.

On the subject of renewals, you no doubt know that while Transport for NSW will send you the renewal paperwork some three to four weeks before its due, you also have three months afterwards to do the deed.

If you go past the date by a couple of days and don't renew

the registration (also applies normal motor vehicle registration) you will receive a letter in the post telling you that you have not renewed and informing you that if it's not done three months from the due date the registration lapses. The letter also reminds you that it's illegal to drive an unregistered vehicle.

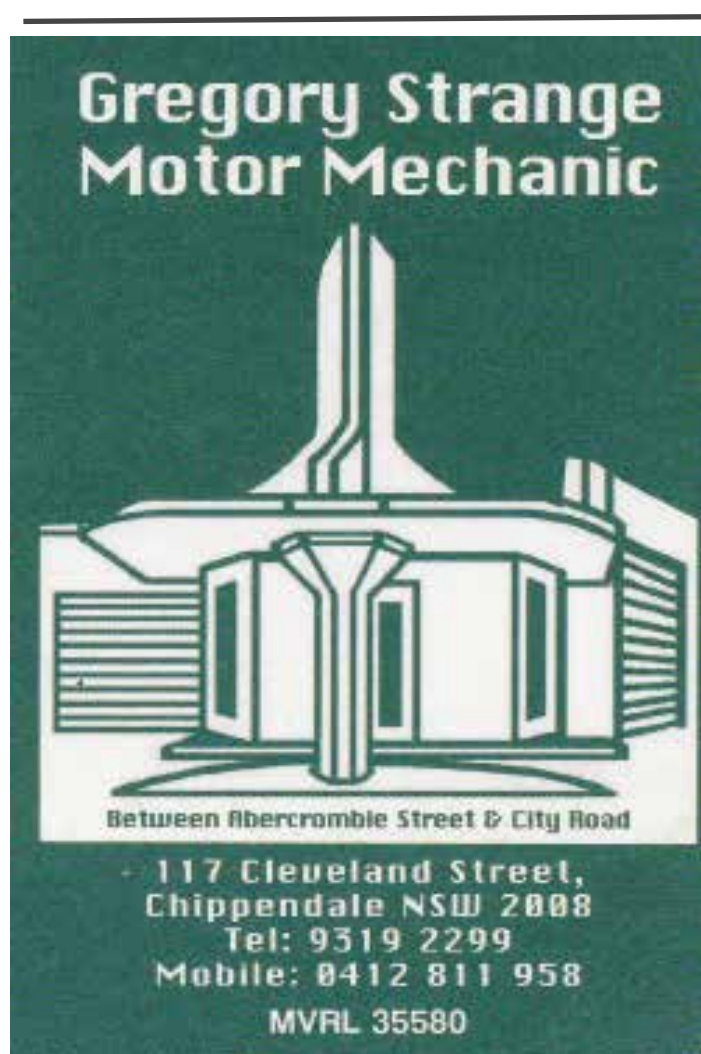
DON'T PANIC!

The above should be read in a calming way. The letter is a standard document sent to everyone who hasn't renewed their registration, not just you.

If another month goes by, you will receive a similar letter, but with different dates indicating two months. In another month you will receive another one. You will not receive a letter saying that your registration has lapsed, but if you do try and register your vehicle you will be politely informed that you can't, as it's lapsed. You will have to start again.

Here they are - the instructions on renewing the Conditional Registration of your car.

- Once you have received the renewal papers from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

Don't forget as the stamped self addressed envelope with a \$1.50 stamp.

cont'from P1

three and a half years in the 1860s. It was surprising to some that the highest point of the railway is at the elevation of 1006 metres.

It was Patrick Quinn's birthday that day and many members later adjourned to Caroline and Patrick's home at Kurrajong Heights for afternoon tea.



Coffee and snacks before the train arrives.

Those present at the Zigzag were:-

Greg Strange & Dianne Lawlor - Sprite Mk 2a, George Goodare - 100M, Patrick and Caroline Quinn - 100 BN3, Russell and Carol Kelly - 3000 MK3, Greg and Kerri Poole - 3000 MK3, Greg Denning and Sue - 3000 MK3, Bob and Angela Ratcliffe - 3000 MK3, Damien Carrick and Alan Hart - 3000 MK3, John and Fran Thornton - BJ9, Lincoln and Carina Sell - BJ9, Keith & Joan Drake - BJ9, Jenny and Ross Penman - BJ9 and Susie Doctor and Denis Kasza - Austin A99 Westminster.



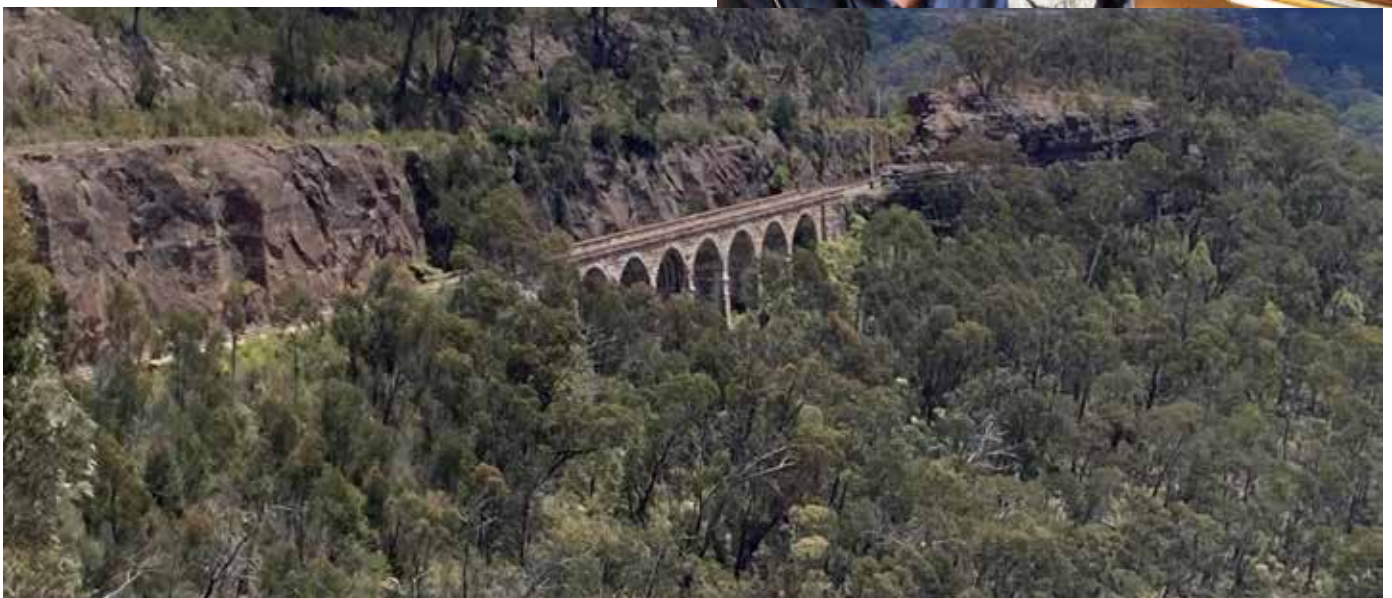
Ross Penman waiting to catch the train.



Carol & Russell Kelly, Jenny & Ross Penman and George Goodare



John and Fran Thornton.



AHOC visits the Zig Zag Railway - Afters at Kurrajong Heights.

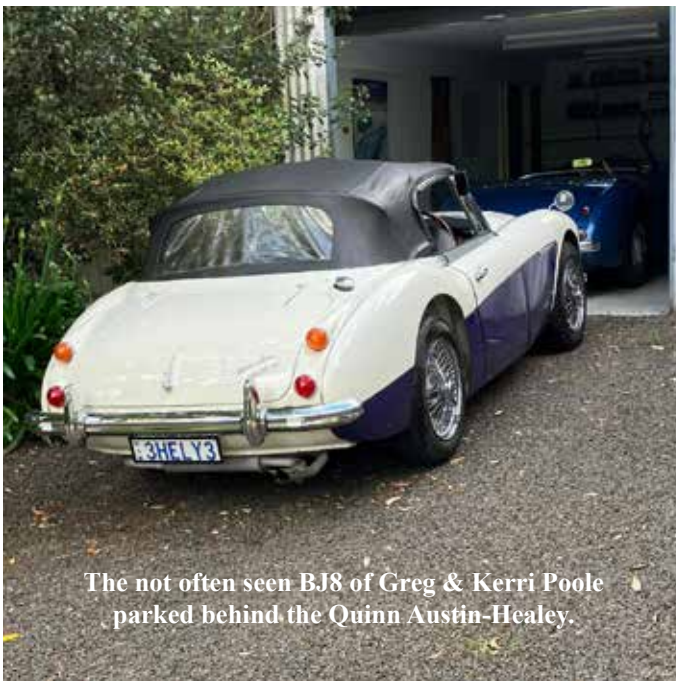
By Patrick Quinn

Years back it was a frequent situation that following an AHOC run or event, many would break their homeward journey by stopping at the home of a member(s) for a cuppa, BBQ or the like.

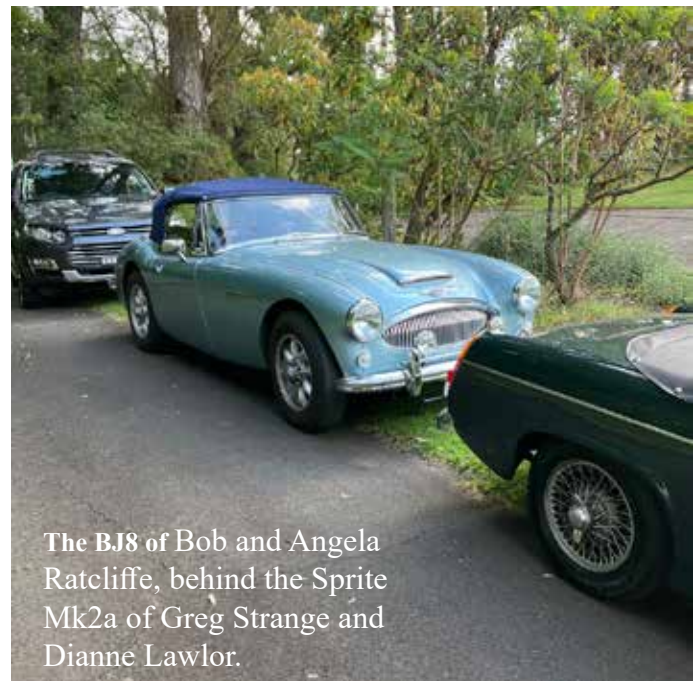
So it was pleasing that some 18 members accepted our invitation to afternoon tea at our home after the Zig Zag. The numbers were increased slightly when Muriel and Ray Roberts joined in with the fun. Thankfully Caroline had been baking for days beforehand.

So not only did they enjoy Bells Line of Road, one of the best driving roads in Australia, but they also consumed plenty of tea, coffee and as much slice and cake they could wish for.

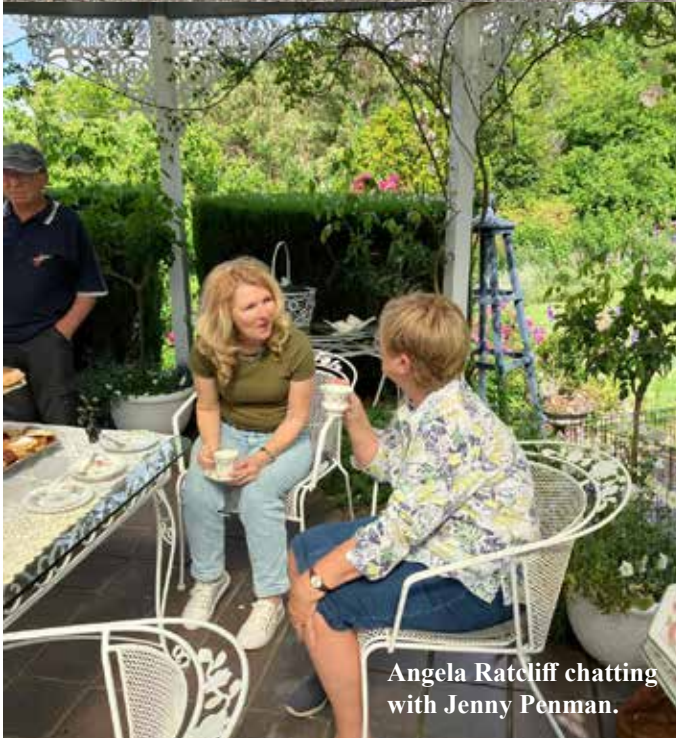
It was a most enjoyable time for everyone and thankyou from Caroline and I for the kind words said about the garden and our home. Thank you also for the birthday wishes to both of us as it was mine on the day and Caroline's three days later.



The not often seen BJ8 of Greg & Kerri Poole parked behind the Quinn Austin-Healey.



The BJ8 of Bob and Angela Ratcliffe, behind the Sprite Mk2a of Greg Strange and Dianne Lawlor.



Angela Ratcliff chatting with Jenny Penman.



AHOC Chapter News

Central Coast Chapter - 2 November by Ian Richter



The weather was not flash, very wet and cool, but there was no stopping those hardy, dedicated souls from the AHOC's Central Coast Chapter who attended the November gathering hosted at our home and more importantly, the shed. As the crowd gathered and the excitement was growing, the ladies in attendance looked on with some disdain at the mere suggestion of walking out to the shed in the wet. Clearly electing not to be part of the enthusiastic spirit of the Austin-Healey gatherings, they quickly set themselves up inside the house on the lounge. The menfolk remained focused and moseyed the 12 metres in the rain to the shed for a look around and some enlightenment.

On being asked back in October if we would host the November gathering, I accepted without hesitation, knowing full well that I had nothing to present. Pressure is your best friend when you need a kick-along. Our BN1 restoration, Maude, is away having some body repairs to the rear shroud, so I was scratching for inspiration. I turned to the rusted, dirt and grease-covered differential and quickly got busy.

The centrepiece for the workshop waffling was the restoration of the BN1's differential, stripped and painted, not too glossy and not too flat. (For those interested, the paint was 2K gloss black with a 20% flattening base. (I follow Colin's rules; well tested). The chat continued on the replacement of Maude's crown wheel and pinion with a shiny new set and a show and tell on the differences between the BN1's four-stud spiral differential and the five-stud hypoid differential that are bolted to all production Austin-Healeys from November 1954 on. We finished off the talk on the repairs to the worn and damaged differential oil seal faces using Speedi sleeves, then back to the house for cake.

Where were the ladies? Still in the comfy chairs.



I thank all those who ventured out. In attendance were Jenni and Ian Richter (hosts), Garry Lee, Doug Ross, Helen and Larry Johns, Annie and Mark McAllan, Roger Ramsey and Greg Denning, who missed the not-so-informative talk but, with impeccable timing, manage to slip in just as the kettle was boiling for the cake, coffee and a chat. I might add that there was not one precious Austin-Healey in sight on the wet day.

December gathering.

The AHOC Central Coast Chapter's December gathering is an Austin-Healey run. We all meet at the Ourimbah rest area on the Western side of the M1 at 9 am for a 9.30 am start. The first leg is to head through the Yarramalong Valley onto Mangrove Dam for morning tea and a look around. You will need to bring your own morning tea. From The Dam, we will head back to Yarramalong township for lunch at Angel Sussurri in Linga Longa Road. The café offers a small bistro menu where you can purchase lunch and refreshments. All are welcome; the more the merrier.

Until next time, Ian and Jenni Richter



Mid-North Coast Chapter

16th November 2024

Present. Tony Ash – Austin-Healey Grille, Di & Al Bryson, Chris & Lyndell Hatch – 100, Glen Nesbit, Glen & Barbara Roberson, Phil & Anthea Lorking. Unfortunately it was NOT Austin-Healey Weather. Apologies - Wally Spychala.

Tony has been improving the air intake for the cabin fresh air and in the process found damaged threads in the grille. These were cleaned and re-tapped.

Al Bryson has rebuilt a set of Sprite carburettors, however one of the jets would not return when operating the choke. We applied a little heat to the

fuel supply pipe and adjusted the actuating lever to improve the situation.

Glen Roberson is having trouble starting the new motor in the MGA he is restoring. We tested both the coil and distributor and found both okay. Perhaps a visit to Glen's workshop is required.

The next gathering will be our Christmas luncheon at the "Riverview Café" North Haven, on Wednesday 18th December. We have booked for 14, just in case a couple of extras turn up.

Merry Christmas to All
Cheers Phil and Anthea Lorking





As 2024 concludes, I need to thank all those who enthusiastically attended the organised events for the “AHOC Illawarra and Southern Highlands Chapters”. It was very heartening to see the response I received each month, not only from local members, but also members from other areas of the state. For the year, we had a total of 177 attendees.

Organising these events does take time, and I especially need to thank David McIntyre for his enthusiastic input, suggesting and organising many of our Chapter’s events. I also must thank Fran for being my personal editor who reviews every notice I send out. This year Fran also took on the running of our largest attended event at Joadja, while I was on ‘leave’.

Our final Chapter event for the year was our Christmas Catch Up at Pipi Shack, Werri Beach. Fran and I were thrilled to host the day. It was a very relaxing social day

that gave us time to admire the cars, and chat, while enjoying a BBQ lunch.

Attendees in Austin-Healeys were David McIntyre BJ8, Ernst & Joan Jensen BT7, Rob & Annie Sassall BT7, Gordon & Louise Lynas Jensen Healey. Our other attendees were Colin & Delwyn Goldsmith and Ray & Murial Roberts.

The last Austin-Healey visit to the Pipi Shack was on 20th April 1997. The photo album was brought out to share a little bit of history and some of these old photos can be found on the AHOC of NSW web site.

Fran and I wish all our Austin-Healey members and friends a very happy Christmas and a wonderful New Year.

John and Fran Thornton



Sydney Car Talk – 1 December by Denis Kasza.



The Mortlake Surf Life Saving Club's premises was again the venue for the AHOC's Sydney Car Talk Gathering. Richard Horwood again very generously hosted the event, with Mark Sullivan assisting.

Morning tea and coffee were looked after thanks to Greg Strange and other members contributed by bringing various goodies. Richard's sausage sizzle brunch was much appreciated and was cooked by Mark.

There were 15 people attending, with eight classic cars on display, plus the many cars on view from Richard's collection.

There was some informative talk regarding the nature of the various Austin-Healey gearboxes versus

cars like the MGB. Along with some lively discussion regarding period vs current finances, brought about by the perusal of an original 1959 BMC Factory Schedule of Recommended Service Charges booklet for the Austin A99. Another topic was the merits of the modern crossply tyre vs modern radial.

Those present were:

Damien Carrick - 3000 MK3, Andrew James - 100/6 BN4, Ronnie Strange - 3000 MK2 BT7 Rod Richards - 3000 MK2 BJ7, Richard Horwood - Mini Cooper and Range Rover, Mark Sullivan - BJ9 Greg Alexander with Greg Strange - Rover 90, Ray Roberts - BJ9, Colin Goldsmith – MGB, Harley Boggis - BMW motorcycle, Rachel Horwood with Dave and Thomas Hodson - BJ9 and Denis Kasza - Austin A99 Westminster.



Sydney Car Talk – Seventh Heaven

Such an important event I even wrote it on the calendar which these days is usually reserved just for medical and hospital appointments.

Getting there is challenging, I've been there 15 times and arrived from 18 different directions; why can't people live somewhere in a proper part of Sydney that's easy to find, and him being an estate agent as well. Just saying! The return journey is even worse, a nightmare. The roads are completely different going the other way. Think I got a bit lost somehow, but was relieved to see the Port Kembla steelworks up ahead. I know my way back to Neutral Bay from there. Today, no problem at all.

Earlier, the weather looked a bit iffy and I decided to be grown-up and responsible and erected the soft top which is hard labour on a roadster especially in 93% humidity. With that done I really needed a shower even though it wasn't a Friday night nor was it my birthday, but I did it anyway. I removed the soft top on the way while topping up with nuclear energy at Lane Cove.

After breakfast I set off at some un-Godly hour with the objective to be at Mortlake before the show was over hoping it was going to be worth the sacrifice.

On arrival at about 9.15 I could see all the important people had gone home which left the remaining rabble firstly, Me and the others in no particular order, Colin, Rod, Greys x 2, Mark, Richard, Denis, Andrew, Damian, Rachelle, Dave, Thomas & Chilli (dog), Ray and Harley. If you are not on the list it's probably a good thing as

you'll probably not get an early morning visit from the police in the near future.

The sausages were very good, I think I had 18 which meant the remaining 6 had to be chopped up and shared between the other people. Halfway through the last one I walked down the street to the swamp and fed it to the crocodiles. As it was the main attraction of the day I made the most of it.

Now, what about the cars! Words escape me but I'll try. Extraordinary, Undeliverable, Gobsmacking, Astounding, Surprising. My eyes, I promise weren't deceiving me. I saw such things as a TOYOTA COROLLA, HONDA CIVIC, HOLDEN CRUSE, FORD FALCON in brown with a 4 cylinder diesel engines with auto, RENAULT 5 all the way from Paris, MAZDA 1,2,3,4,5&6 all in red. NISSAN MICRA, VOLVO 240, MITSUBISHI COLT, MORRIS MARINA, SKODA 100 and CITROEN 200 all the way from well south of Paris, but not a Le Mans winner, and a PRIUS. This is just the tip of the volcano; more eye and mouth watering exotica lurks within SEVENTH HEAVEN if you know where to look and if you can stand the exhilaration.

The value of these cars would be beyond my comprehension and I naturally called John from Bonham's Auctions and Bob from Coys of Kensington Auction and gave them a list of these cars. they haven't returned my call. They must also be overwhelmed and speechless.

RONNIE





FROM THE AHOC Vic PRESIDENT

By now you would have probably seen the booking forms for the 2025 National Rally being hosted by the AHOC of Victoria at the RACV resort at Inverloch, a seaside town 140 kilometres south east of Melbourne. Following the running of the successful West Australian Rally at Geraldton, bookings are now open for the 2025 Rally to members of Australian Austin-Healey clubs.

If you have not been to a National Rally before, you should make the effort and join us at Inverloch, as I am sure you will enjoy yourself.

We have put together a great program of events and the location of the RACV resort is inviting. As well as daytime tours and events, we will gather each evening at the resort for dinner where you will meet new friends and catch up with old ones.

After the final breakfast together, there is the opportunity to travel to the Phillip Island Grand Prix Circuit to witness the first day of action at the largest Historic Motorsport meeting in the Southern Hemisphere.

Once registered for the Rally, we will keep you up to date with developments and events that will be in store for you during your time at the Rally.

Terry Wade





2025 AUSTIN HEALEY NATIONAL RALLY

TUESDAY MARCH 4 TILL FRIDAY MARCH 7

VENUE - RACV RESORT INVERLOCH VICTORIA

ADULTS ATTENDING:

(One person must be a member of a State or National Austin Healey Club!)

1.		2.	
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PERSONAL DETAILS:

Contact street address:			
Suburb:		State:	Postcode:
Telephone:	Home:	Mobile:	
Email address:		State / National Healey Club Membership number:	

Special Dietary requirements (if any):

--

RALLY COSTS:

Adults x	@ \$500.00 ea	TOTAL:	\$
TOTAL AMOUNT DUE:			\$

****Full payment for adult and child tickets must be received by December 31st, 2024.****

**PAYMENT METHODS:**

Payment by: <i>(please highlight)</i>	Cheque:		Direct Deposit:	
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PAYMENT DETAILS:

CHEQUE: Please make all cheques payable to: AHOC of Vic. Inc. Mail to: AHOC of Vic 2025 Rally, 59 Sanders Road, Frankston South, 3199 VIC	BANK TRANSFER (Preferred) : Please use initial and surname as reference: Account: AUSTIN HEALEY OWNERS CLUB OF VIC INC Bank: National Australia Bank BSB: 083-153 Account Number: 12 374 6259
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PLEASE NOTE: RECEIPTS WILL BE ISSUED ON PAYMENT

ENQUIRIES: Email : 2025rally@healeyvic.com.au

HOW WILL YOU TRAVEL?

Are you travelling to the National Rally in an Austin Healey? <i>(please highlight)</i>	Yes	No
If yes, what is the Model No / Type / Colour:		

TERMS AND CONDITIONS:

Refund Policy – The AHOC of Vic Rally Committee takes no responsibility for Accommodation bookings made directly with the RACV Inverloch or any alternative accommodation selected by rally attendees.
 Rally participants must check with their chosen accommodation providers regarding any refund policy offered.

Any refund of Rally Ticket costs will be at the discretion of the AHOC of Vic Rally Committee and no refund request will be considered post 31 January 2025 under any but extreme circumstances.

Disclaimer – All Rally attendees enter and participate in the 2025 National Rally solely at their own risk.
 By lodging a Rally Registration application, attendees release the AHOC of Vic Inc and it's Rally Committee from any and all liability for loss, damage or injury to participants or their vehicles.

Ticket inclusions - Your Rally Ticket includes 3 evening functions including entertainment, meals and drinks (limited to beer, wine and soft drinks.):

- 3 Evening functions at resort
- Various attractions at Port Albert
- 1 lunch
- 1 Farewell Breakfast
- Rally Pack
- A great time with all your Healey Friends!

IN ORDER TO CONFIRM REGISTRATION PLEASE POST OR E MAIL THIS COMPLETED FORM TO:

AHOC of Vic 2025 Rally,
 59 Sanders Road, Frankston South, 3199
 OR : 2025rally@healeyvic.com.au

REGALIA

Regalia order forms will be sent separately.

ACCOMMODATION

See separate accommodation booking form.

Accommodation to be arranged directly with RACV Inverloch



2025 AUSTIN HEALEY NATIONAL RALLY

Tuesday March 4th to Friday March 7th

To be held at RACV Inverloch Resort, Victoria

ACCOMODATION OPTIONS

Premium Ocean View 	Perfect for couples with panoramic views of the Bass Coast and private balcony, ensuite, flat screen TV, microwave, fridge and are located in the main building. All rooms have an allocated parking space.	\$351.30 per night – excluding breakfast
Ocean view 	Ocean View Rooms offer a private balcony, ensuite, flat screen TV, microwave, fridge and are located in the main building. All rooms have an allocated parking space.	\$297.00 per night – excluding breakfast
Deluxe 2 bed cabins 	Scattered throughout the Resort, they feature two bedrooms, one queen bed and one with twin bedding. they have a separate spacious living area, private balcony and one bathroom. Parking at each pod of rooms. 5 to 10 Mins walk to main lodge.	\$258.30 per night /room only(Max 3 guests)



Resort rooms 	Resort rooms are a basic hotel room with bathroom, bar fridge and tea coffee making facilities. These rooms have no deck, no view and are not located in the main building. Bedding configuration can be King or twin. 5 to 10 Mins walk to main lodge.	\$243.00 per night / room only (Max 2 guests)
Standard 2bed villas 	Scattered throughout the resort the Villas feature two spacious bedrooms, both can be either king or twin bedding. The villa has a shared bathroom and toilet as well as a central living area. parking is allocated at each pod of rooms. 5 to 10 Mins walk to main lodge.	\$402.30 per night / room only (Maximum of 4 guests)

Room pricing is based on RACV Member rates by special arrangements with the resort.

Note – more accommodation arrangements MAY be available – enquire directly with the resort for details.

Reservations are to be made on an INDIVIDUAL basis.

- Rates above are room only rates and breakfast is an additional charge per person of \$24.00pd. Guests can add breakfast to their booking upon check in. Alternatively, guests can book breakfast in our Radius restaurant and pay for it on the day.
- Rooms will be held until October 31st, 2024 to allow for your group to book. RACV Inverloch reserve the right to release any rooms not booked by this date and bookings will become subject to availability.
- Rates are valid until the 31st of October 2024 any rooms booked post this date will be subject to available rates at the time of booking.
- Individual reservations will be processed by Reception and not the Conference and events team.



To make a new reservation via a convenient booking link

Follow the following link:

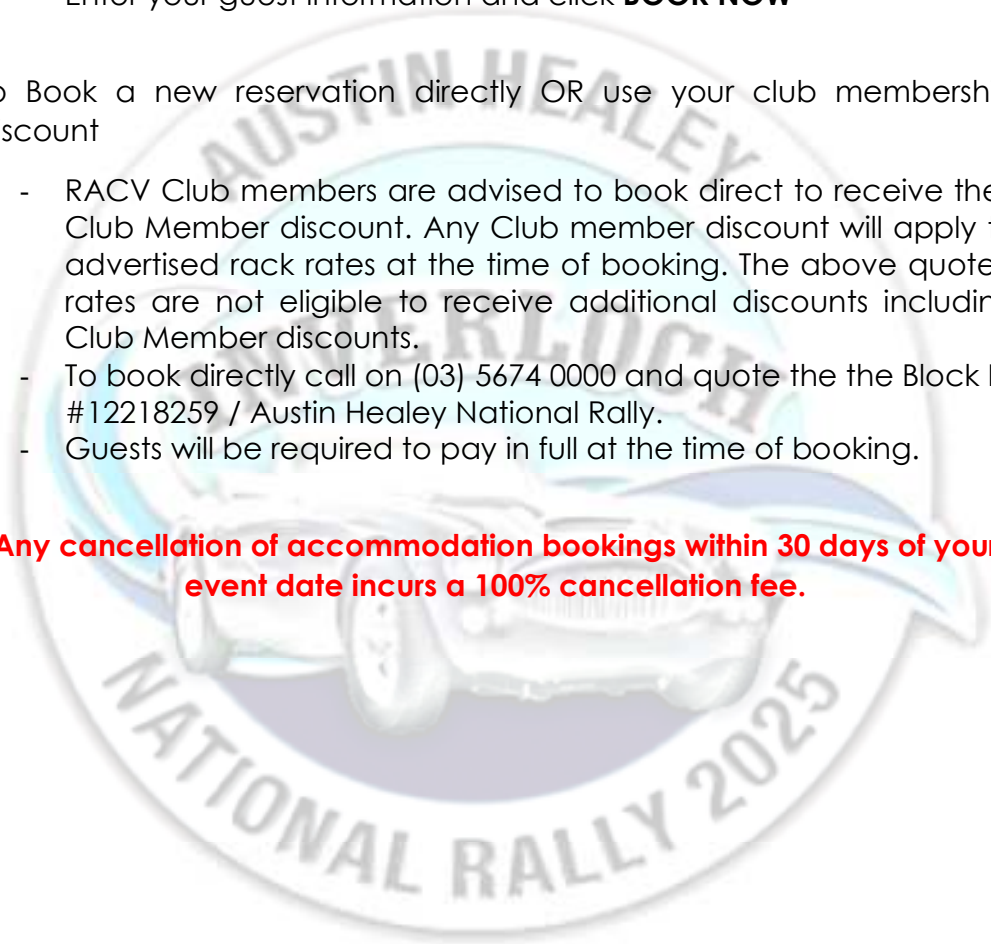
[http://bookings.ihotelier.com/bookings.jsp?groupID=4392528
&hotelID=72449](http://bookings.ihotelier.com/bookings.jsp?groupID=4392528&hotelID=72449)

- Select number of guests and date of stay
- Select your room type
- Enter your guest information and click **BOOK NOW**

To Book a new reservation directly OR use your club membership discount

- RACV Club members are advised to book direct to receive their Club Member discount. Any Club member discount will apply to advertised rack rates at the time of booking. The above quoted rates are not eligible to receive additional discounts including Club Member discounts.
- To book directly call on (03) 5674 0000 and quote the the Block ID #12218259 / Austin Healey National Rally.
- Guests will be required to pay in full at the time of booking.

Any cancellation of accommodation bookings within 30 days of your event date incurs a 100% cancellation fee.





AUSTIN HEALEY



NATIONAL RALLY



Caps \$20 each
Grey, Blue, White

Polo Shirt Sizes:
Ladies – 6 to 26
Mens – Small to 12XL
Caps – one size fits all



Polo Shirts
\$35 each
Grey, Blue, White

ORDER FORM

Polo Shirts: Number, Size/s & Colour/s
eg 1x L14 Blue or 2x M2XL 1Grey 1White

Caps: Number, Colour/s: G B W

Total Amount due:

Name: **Phone:**

Address:

Email:

BANK TRANSFER ONLY: Account Austin Healey Owners Club of Victoria
Bank National Australia Bank BSB 083-153 Account Number 12374 6259
Please reference: Regalia with your initial and surname

RETURN ORDER FORM TO: Reg McNee 3/13 Washington Street, Toorak 3134 or
Email Reg McNee reginaldamcnee@gmail.com
Any questions call Reg McNee on 0434 242 013. or email reginaldamcnee@gmail.com





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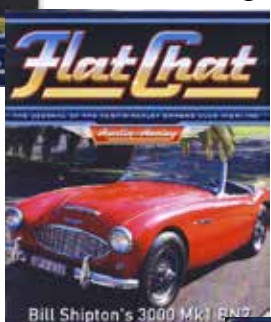
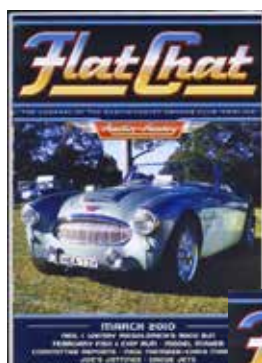
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Flat Chat Back Issues

Interested in receiving backcopies of Flat Chat?
Now available, digital copies of Flat Chat for 2005
through to December 2024.

That's 220+ issues for you to read at your leisure.
Free and gratis to members. All you have to do is send
a 1-3GB USB (thumb) drive to me at the below address
along with a stamped self-address envelope.



Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



Slow Road to Inverloch - Update

You may have seen the flyer for this tour in last month's Flat Chat Newsletter. Since then, a number of people have booked, but there is still plenty of space for you to join us on what I'm sure will be a very enjoyable tour. The southeast coast is a beautiful part of the world and has roads that were largely laid out when our cars were new. In other words, they are great for cruising in an Austin-Healey! (Not too bad in a tin-top either!)

In addition to the details in last month's Flat Chat Newsletter I have included a second night at Lakes Entrance for those who wish to linger a little longer before driving home. If you wish to take up this option, please let me know when you make your booking.

As mentioned last month, this trip is for those who enjoy visiting a number of towns and having time to enjoy the scenery as they travel in the company of like-minded people.

The route is a leisurely wander to Inverloch via Nowra, Merimbula and Lakes Entrance before arriving at Inverloch in time for the National Rally, which starts on Tuesday 4 March. Even if you aren't attending the Rally, you can still travel with us to Lakes Entrance. As this is a perambulation to the Rally, the trip home is not included, but there are many options to tempt you on that return trip.

Depending on where your journey begins, I am planning to begin with a shortish drive to Nowra on Thursday 27th February, where we will stay at the George Bass Motel. This is off the main road, but centrally located in Nowra. We will meet to enjoy a welcoming drink and tasty dinner as we get together at our first stop. Nowra is 170kms (2hrs30) from Sydney.

On Friday 28th February we travel to Merimbula, staying for two nights. That is about 310kms and a 4hrs drive. There are a variety of pubs, restaurants and clubs in town for breakfasts, lunches and dinners. Saturday is a day for relaxing and enjoying this beautiful lakeside town.



Sunday 2 March will see us drive to Lakes Entrance, that is about 270kms or three hrs driving from Merimbula. As mentioned, you have the option of staying one or two nights here. Some of us will be continuing to Inverloch on Monday, however lakes Entrance seems a long way to go for a single night if you aren't going to the Rally, so please take the option of having another night here before returning home. Lakes Entrance is 254kms or 3hrs10 driving time from Inverloch.

There are a number of options besides returning the way we came, such as: returning to Orbost then heading via Delegate, Cooma and Canberra; continuing to Melbourne and returning via the Hume Highway; or perhaps trekking over the Victorian



Lakes Entrance - Photo – Visitvictoria.



High Country to Omeo, Bright and on via Albury or Corryong and Tumut. There are plenty of options, so get out your old maps and find an enjoyable route that Google Maps would never offer.

Unfortunately, the Victorian AHOC seems to have chosen a popular time of year for the National Rally. As a result, I have had to change some locations which has slightly increased the cost. Depending on the room option chosen, the accommodation cost

of this trip is \$400 per person on a twin share basis, plus \$110 per person for the second night at Lakes Entrance if you choose that option.

Please contact Gordon at glynas@icloud.com, or call me on 0403 198 343 to book your place.

Happy Healeying

Gordon



Being able to ignore what may be in the contents, I have always liked Chiko Rolls.

Thanks to Ray Roberts for reminding me.

Remember a 1955 Chiko Roll today.

FOR SALE**FOR SALE**

Stuart McColl offers the following six-cylinder Austin-Healey spares for sale:-

Two 12 port cast iron cylinder heads. In excellent condition having not received any machining from when fitted new to a car. Have been cracked tested and both have valves fitted.

Triple SUs and inlet manifold as fitted to a Mk2 Roadster with exhaust manifolds.

Six knock-ons. Four are unused repros and two are re-chromed originals.

Repro front bumper with two re-chromed overriders.

Stuart may be contacted on 0412 551 878.

Austin-Healey Windscreens



The AHOC is pleased to announce that there are a number of new Austin-Healey replacement windscreens.

They are extremely well priced at \$280 each, irrespective of the model.

If interested please contact Colin Rule on 0467 563 523.

**For Sale - Wanted**

Pair Austin-Healey rear seat pans, fibreglass.
\$80.00

Rear Brake drums BN1 from CE221536 (These early model drums are no longer available).
\$100.00

For Sale - Wanted

Austin-Healey 3000 12 port Cylinder head. Good condition \$550.00

All could be picked up from me at northern beaches.

Please call Peter Ford on 0412 084 062

For Sale - Wanted**For 100 BN1**

Gearbox & Overdrive complete, Louvered bonnet (red), Generator, Distributor, Starter, Voltage Regulator, H4 SUs on manifolds, Oil pump, Flywheel, Timing Chain (New), Knock-on tool, Rocker gear, 100 Sales Brochure, Workshop Manual, Driver's Handbook, Knock on hubs (2), Aeroquip flexible brake lines (3)

For 3000 BJ8

Oil Filter Housings, Screw-on Oil Filter

Lucas P700 Headlamps (good condition)

Please call David Harries on 0420 488 804

WANTED:

3000MK1 OR MK11 – Right handed Brake Caliper mounting bracket (just the bracket – not the caliper)

Prepared to purchase a set if available - left or right mounting brackets.

Please call Patrick on 0417 673 065

AHOC member Darren Freeman of Peninsula Sports Cars offers two BJ8s for sale. Darren may be contacted at (02) 9907 2069

[AD-17665141/](#)
Asking \$88,950 ono.

This red finished car (HBJ8/30929) had been in a garage for 10-15 years and has undergone a full recommission. Included brakes rebuilt, carbs rebuilt, fuel lines and fuel pump replaced, electrical system checked and rectified where needed, steering box adjusted, front suspension checked and bushes replaced as required.

Link to the carsales ad.

<https://www.carsales.com.au/cars/details/x/SSE->

Project car (HBJ8L/35347) has been stripped ready for paint and panel, and has 90% of parts with it in varying condition. No rust other than some very slight surface rust in a couple of places. Small ding in driver's side wing, and front valence needs a tidy up, otherwise a straight car.

Photos at <https://photos.app.goo.gl/AzMV7ovA2AtUJK-MG8>

Asking \$49,500 ono

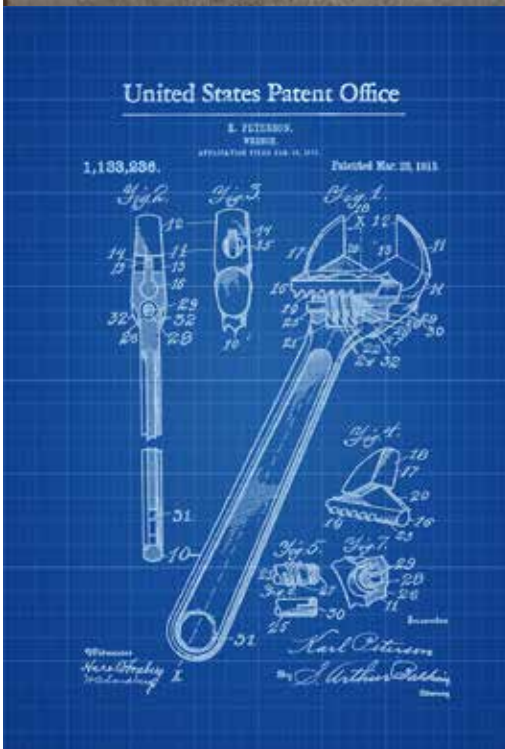


Your Last Page



What more could you ask for?

A sophisticated young man and his Austin-Healey 100.



Probably the most useful item in your toolbox while being very capable at rounding bolt heads.



Meanwhile filling up in the US.

Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**